



# Delve

A Dungeon Exploration Game

2-5 Players | Ages 8+ | 45-90 Minutes

## Overview

You are a crew of dungeon explorers; brave, foolish, or somewhere in between. Together you descend into ancient ruins, drawing tiles to develop the map as you go, solving puzzles, surviving encounters, and racing to claim the most treasure before the dungeon collapses around you.

You escape together, but only one leaves with the glory.

## Components

- Dungeon tile pieces: Floor 1 (required) - Floor 2 (required), Floor 3 (for longer games)
- Puzzle & Encounter card deck: divided into Basic, Intermediate, and Advanced Piles
- 1 Win Tile (the Ancient Vault- Worth 4 points)
- 2 Custom dice: one Movement Die (Faces: 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 2), and one Action Die (Faces: 0, 0, 1, 1)
- 5 Role Cards with Health sliders and Ability Trackers
- 1 sand timer (90 seconds)



## Setup

1. Place the dungeon entrance token with space in between them at the bottom of your playing area in ascending order.
2. Shuffle the Basic, Intermediate, and Advanced action decks separately and place them face-down
3. Set the Win Tile aside- it gets shuffled into the active tile pile only when the final floor is reached
4. Select role cards equal to the number of players and distribute them randomly to each player. Set each Health slider to full and place player tokens on the starting tile (floor 1)

# How to Play

At the beginning of your turn, roll both the Action and Movement Dice

## Movement Die

- 0- You do not move. If you roll a 0 with the action die, trigger your role's special ability
- 1- Move to an adjacent tile, or expand the dungeon by drawing and placing a new tile
- 2- Move up to two tiles, or draw and place one new tile and move onto it

## Action Die

- 0- If you roll a 0 with the Movement die, trigger your role's special ability
- 1- After your movement, draw an encounter card corresponding to the difficulty level of the tile your player token is on. If you are on a starwell, draw a Basic card

## Placing New Tiles

When you move into unexplored space, draw the top tile from the floor pile and place it in any orientation you choose. Each tile has at least one entrance and one exit. You cannot place a tile so that it creates an impossible connection. The color of the tile indicates its difficulty level: Green- Basic, Yellow- Intermediate, and Red- Advanced

## Encounters

When an Encounter card is triggered, a non-active player draws the card and conceals the answer before reading it aloud or showing it to the active player. Other players may not help. The player has 90 seconds to complete riddles, and combat lasts until only one is left standing.

Upon success, the active player claims the card and gains its effect, either a permanent buff or a point value

On puzzle failure, the active player loses 1 health and the card is discarded

On combat failure, the player skips their next turn and regains half max health

## Combat

When a combat card is drawn, another player takes responsibility for playing that enemy. The active and enemy players take turns rolling the action dice, and damage is dealt based on the

description on each character. Upon success, the active player claims the card and gains its effect. On combat failure, the active player skips their next turn and restores half max health.

## Health

HP is tracked via the slider on each Role Card. HP is lost from failed puzzles and combat

When a player reaches 0 HP, they sit out their next turn to rest. At the start of their following turn, they return with half health.

## End Game & The Win Tile

When the final floor becomes active, the Win Tile — the Ancient Vault — is shuffled into the tile pile.

When a player draws and rolls an encounter on the Ancient Vault, they claim it for 4 points. Every other player then gets one final turn, then all explorers escape.

Tally up all point cards. The player with the most points wins and earns the title of **Master Delver**.

## Role Cards



- **The Scout**
  - HP: 4
  - Passive: Goes first at the start of the game.
  - Special (on 0): Full Reroll — re-roll both dice and use the new result.
- **The Magician**
  - HP: 3
  - Passive: Once per floor, may look at the top card of an encounter and place it on bottom before triggering an encounter.
  - Special (on 0): Arcane Grab — roll the Movement Die and steal the top card from the corresponding pile (0 = Basic, 1 = Intermediate, 2 = Advanced) without triggering an event.
- **The Archaeologist**
  - HP: 3
  - Passive: May rotate any tile 180 degrees after placement, once per turn.
  - Special (on 0): Ancient Knowledge — look at the top 3 tiles in the current floor pile, select 2, and place them without moving.
- **The Knight**
  - HP: 5
  - Passive: When another player on the same tile fails an encounter, the Knight may spend their next turn to let that player re-attempt another of the same difficulty. If they succeed, both players earn half the points (rounded down).
  - Special (on 0): Tactical Swap — switch positions with any one other player.
- **The Rogue**

- HP: 3
- Passive: Once per floor, may discard an Encounter or Trap card without attempting it and without penalty.
- Special (on 0): Reroll the Event Die only.

## Expansion Packs (Optional)

- **Floor 4 Tiles** — A brutal fourth layer with more Vaults and exclusively Advanced encounters.
- **Boss Encounter Pack** — Multi-stage Boss cards shuffled into the Advanced pile, worth 5 points.
- **Curse Cards** — Ongoing effect cards that apply penalties until a puzzle is solved.
- **Additional Roles** — New explorers like the Alchemist or Cartographer with unique mechanics.

## Quick Reference

- Movement Die: 0 = Special Ability, 1 = move 1, 2 = move up to 2 Event Die:
- Encounter = draw a card (Chamber/Vault only), Nothing = no event Corridor =
- Basic (1pt) | Chamber = Intermediate (2pt) | Vault = Advanced (3pt)
- Win Tile = 4 points, triggers final round
- 0 HP = sit out one turn, return at 1 HP
- Timer: 60 sec Basic/Intermediate, 90 sec Advanced



## Playtesting

- My family seemed to generally like the idea
- My mom suggested that I include more eng-game goals or themes for gameplay, so players can do different adventures, like “zombie apocalypse” or “huanted mansion” or whatever.
- Target audience should be “minecraft” age